

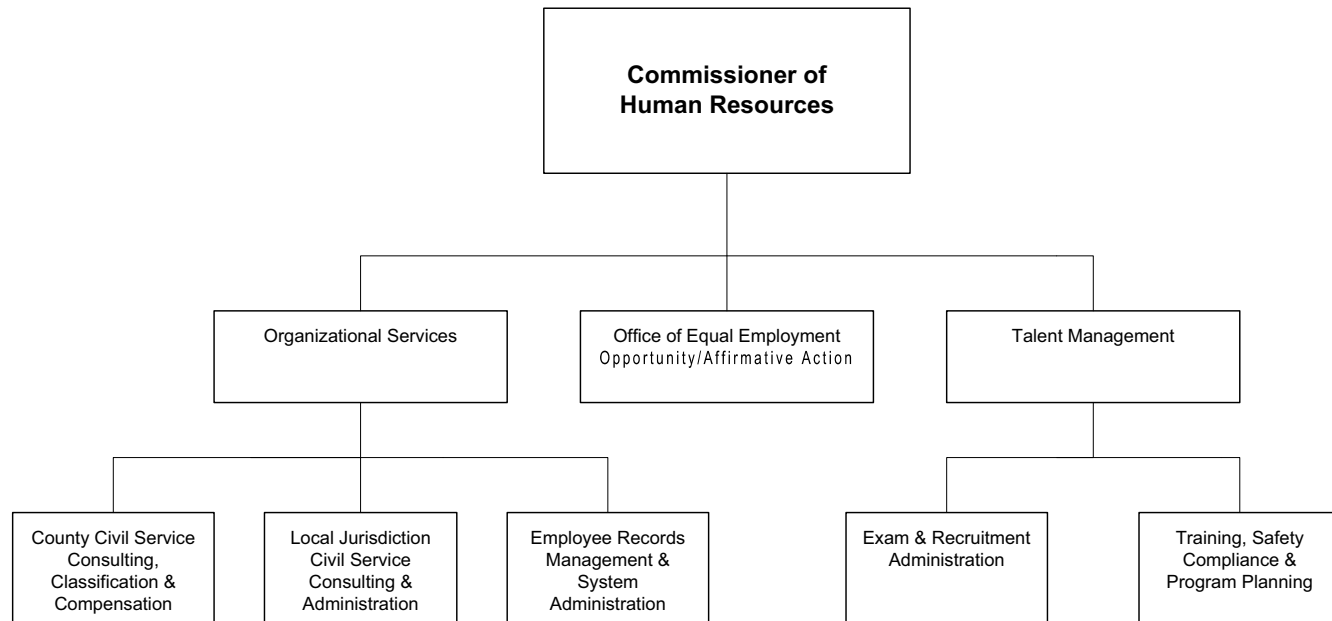
County Executive (11)

Account Title	Program Amount	Program Amount	<u>Current Year Program Amount: Funding Breakdown</u>			
	Prior Year	Current Year	Federal	State	Adv. to Grants	Other
Westchester County Domestic Violence High Risk Team	\$250,000	\$250,000	\$250,000			

Acct T-G042 11-W042. Granting Agency: U.S. Department of Justice, Office on Violence Against Women. The purpose is to operate a county wide multidisciplinary high-risk team focusing on reducing serious physical harm and/or lethality in domestic violence cases. The goal is to reduce these harms through the use of the Jackie Campbell risk assessment and a team approach to connect victims with safety planning and essential services at the earliest point of contact and to envelop victims with a team that will continually communicate and monitor risk to increase safety Term: 10/1/21-09/30/25.

Westchester County

Human Resources (12)



The Commissioner of Human Resources is appointed by the County Executive, subject to confirmation by the Board of Legislators.

Human Resources (12)

Mission Statement

Consistent with the principles of merit and fitness and a workplace free of harassment and discrimination, it is the mission of the Department of Human Resources to recruit, train, support and retain the most capable workforce for Westchester County Departments and over 120 local government agencies to ensure that the public benefits from a talented, diverse workforce able to meet the needs of a dynamic County.

	2024	2025
POSITIONS		
Operating	52	52
Grants		
	52	52
OPERATING BUDGET EXPENDITURES		
Personal Services	4,908,373	5,130,742
Equipment		
Material & Supplies	32,677	23,000
Expenses	1,191,887	1,390,119
Interdepartmental Charges	805,123	864,929
TOTAL EXPENDITURES	6,938,060	7,408,790
OPERATING BUDGET REVENUES		
Interdepartmental	777,932	758,087
Departmental	261,600	561,600
State and Federal Aid		
TOTAL REVENUES	1,039,532	1,319,687
DEPARTMENT TAX LEVY	5,898,528	6,089,103
Estimated Share of Miscellaneous Budget Items:		
Retirement Systems	1,164,966	1,263,299
Health Insurance and Benefits	1,833,029	1,904,918
DEPARTMENT TOTAL	8,896,523	9,257,320

The Appropriated 2024 figures in the supporting detail include all budget amendments through August 31, 2024 and Appropriations Assigned for Purchases on Order ("roll forwards") of \$5,080.

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The Department of Human Resources is responsible for Civil Service administration for all County departments and local jurisdictions in Westchester County as mandated by New York State Civil Service Law. In addition, the Department of Human Resources provides oversight of various County administrative processes involving personnel policy and procedures and union contract compliance, and ensures compliance with applicable Federal and State laws, rules and regulations. The Department is required to operate under the following New York State Laws and State Codes, Rules and Regulations:

Programs and Services

To implement and enforce all provisions of the NYS Civil Service Law for all County positions and municipal subdivisions under the Civil Service jurisdiction of Westchester County.

To enforce all provisions of Federal, State and County Law and rules relating to employment matters including but not limited to Family Medical Leave Act, Fair Labor Standards Act, Wage History Legislation, Public Employer Workplace Violence Prevention and training in Sexual Harassment Prevention.

In accordance with the new Ethics Code adopted by the Board of Legislators in 2021, the Human Resources department is charged with managing the annual Financial Disclosure Statements for all officers and employees required to file.

State Law or Regulations

NYS Civil Service Law, Section 17 and Westchester County Charter Section 179.31, in conformance with the 1937 Laws of New York State, Chapter 617.

To enforce all provisions of State and County Law and rules relating to employment harassment or discrimination including but not limited to the Equal Pay Act, the Civil Rights Act of 1964, the Pregnancy Discrimination Act, Age Discrimination in Employment Act, the Americans with Disabilities Act as amended, the New York State Sexual Harassment Prevention Act and the Westchester County Equal Employment Opportunity Policy, the Anti-Harassment and Discrimination Policy and the Sexual Harassment Prevention Policy, the Fair Chance to Work Policy (EO 5-2018), and the Wage History Anti-Discrimination Law (Local Law 2018-1)

Human Resources (12)

PROGRAM AREA AND SERVICES:

GENERAL GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

✓ Administrative Services

- ◆ Support the daily operations of government Human Resources and Civil Service administration.
- ◆ Manage the online Employee Evaluation system for the various County departments; train new supervisors in the system and work with the vendor to upload evaluations and reporting hierarchy when adding new departments to the system
- ◆ Oversee pre-employment background and criminal records checks, eligible list restrictions, Section 55a appointments, fit-for-duty evaluations, required drug testing, and federal/state mandated medical services.
- ◆ Oversee Office of Equal Employment Opportunity/Affirmative Action for County employees; facilitates Sexual Harassment Training, EEO Self-Audit, EEO-4 Reports and submission of Affirmative Action Plans. Manages EEO-AA complaints from Intake through Final Determination and Recommendation.
- ◆ Spearhead the County's involvement in the Government Alliance on Race and Equality (GARE) network, through the EEO office, by updating our exam/jobs posting recruitment distribution list of organizations to ensure greater diversity and inclusion; developed targeted lists of community organizations, schools, and online associations by department and job groups to assist departments to reach a more diverse audience for their job openings.
- ◆ Manage employee recognition and employee discount programs.
- ◆ Administer the County's Workplace Violence Prevention program in compliance with NY State law, coordinating a multi-department Committee and the mandated annual training.
- ◆ Commissioner serves as a member of the Deferred Compensation Board.
- ◆ Coordinate department's response to FOIL requests.
- ◆ Manage departmental contracts and county-wide contracts for drug/medical testing and temp personnel services.

- ◆ Develop recruitment campaigns for difficult to recruit positions and expand the candidate pool with targeted populations.
- ◆ Lead Countywide staff development and planning initiative to enhance employee professional development, meet State mandates for workplace violence and harassment prevention training, develop supervisors, enhance customer service, orient new employees, improve employees' job skills, and develop employees' career growth with the government through tuition reimbursement and reduction programs.

✓ County Department Services

- ◆ Administer New York State Civil Service Law and Westchester County Civil Service Rules for all County departments, Westchester Community College and Westchester Medical Center.
- ◆ Meet and work closely with County departments, including the Westchester Community College and Westchester Medical Center to review various classification, compensation and organizational proposals in order to provide advice and facilitate requests.
- ◆ Conduct comprehensive salary surveys as needed.
- ◆ Prepare, modify and review job descriptions for all titles in County departments, Westchester Community College and Westchester Medical Center; make recommendations for jurisdictional classifications outside the competitive class, conduct public hearings and prepare documentation for State approval.
- ◆ Meet and work closely with departmental representatives to review proposals, provide advice and facilitate staffing changes and discuss opportunities for budgetary savings.
- ◆ Administer various provisions of negotiated labor agreements for all County departments.
- ◆ Conduct layoff analyses for all County departments including the Westchester Community College and Westchester Medical Center as needed.

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✓ Employee Records and Data Management

- ◆ Audit and maintain required detailed employment and position records for all County and local employees and perform payroll certification for civil service compliance.
- ◆ Ongoing support and oversight of various applications used in Human Resources for services throughout the County such as the HR/Payroll system, the Building Access Control system, background check applications, and OnBase Document Management system.
- ◆ Oversee Countywide compliance with the Family Medical Leave Act by centralized administration of the provisions of this law. Provide training to departmental representatives as needed to ensure on-going compliance.

✓ Local Government Services

- ◆ Administer New York State Civil Service Law and Westchester County Civil Service Rules for 122 local government agencies (Towns, Villages, Cities of Rye and Peekskill, school and special districts) under the County's civil service jurisdiction.
- ◆ Meet and work closely with local municipal governments, school and special districts to study positions to ensure proper classification, review proposals for new positions and department reorganization, provide advisement on both routine and complex civil service issues, train contacts in basic civil service reporting requirements and facilitate various requests, such as status of eligible lists, medical fit for duty evaluations and civil service roster reporting matters.
- ◆ Maintain the classification plan and create, prepare, modify and review all job specifications for titles used in local jurisdictions.
- ◆ Make recommendations for jurisdictional classifications outside of the competitive class, conduct public hearings and prepare

supporting documentation for review and approval by New York State Civil Service Commission.

- ◆ Review documentation to determine eligibility of candidates for reinstatement or transfer in accordance with Civil Service Law and Rules.
- ◆ Assist local agencies with resolving discrepancies disclosed as the result of the annual payroll audit and certification process.
- ◆ Conduct layoff analyses for local municipal governments, school and special districts due to proposed reductions in the work force.
- ◆ Provide access to secure website for Local municipalities, school districts' authorized civil service contacts to provide them with updated forms and procedure manuals.

✓ Talent Management and Exam Administration

- ◆ Review applications for approximately 12,000 candidates per year for examinations, local or County pre-clearances for the competitive or non-competitive class, according to the established criteria.
- ◆ Arrange and administer required written, performance, agility and medical examinations which conform to all civil service and civil rights laws.
- ◆ Facilitate provisional control and maintain a stable workflow by auditing the appropriate internal reports in conjunction with the data from New York State Civil Service Commission.
- ◆ Audit all documentation, application folders, grades and reports in accordance with the internal procedures to prepare and establish all civil service eligible lists resulting from the civil service written examinations.
- ◆ Prepare, certify and audit all civil service eligible lists and audit all eligible list appointments for compliance with civil service law for all County departments and local municipal agencies.
- ◆ Provide comprehensive training and ongoing support in making eligible list appointments and explaining the appointment process

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to the appointing authorities under the civil service jurisdiction of Westchester County.

- ◆ Deliver excellent customer service support to our candidates and appointing authorities, resolve telephone, email or walk-in inquiries and assist them with their needs.

DEPARTMENT INITIATIVES:

NEW

- ✓ Recruited and on-boarded new Recruitment Coordinator to assist County to transform its recruitment strategy including working with Communication Department on developing and disseminating a recruitment video for social media.
- ✓ Created protocol for uniformed services candidates to appeal a failed psychological evaluation; identified a vendor to perform second opinion evaluations and worked with Law to draft a contract with vendor.
- ✓ Administer the annual Financial Disclosure Statements for all officers and employees required to file, in accordance with the new Ethics Code adopted by the Board of Legislators in 2021; collaborate with IT to test and refine the newly launched system; continue to refine and administer the in-person and online Ethics training for County employees and Board Members.
- ✓ Work with DOH to revise the County's lactation policy in accordance with the additional new State law, and continue to help coordinate appropriate lactation rooms for employees.
- ✓ Create Domestic Violence response flow chart with Office for Women and Workplace Violence Committee input.
- ✓ HR Commissioner created appropriate protocols in response to increased "1st Amendment Audits," and developed and delivered related training for County managers.
- ✓ Executed contract for reviewing Medical Standards for Correction Officer selection., and participated in kick-off/planning meetings with vendor and DOC.
- ✓ Work with IT to move the Tuition Reimbursement application to an online "self-service" process for employees.
- ✓ Develop and coordinate supervisory training on new topics each year such as EAP Resources, Managing Remote Workers, and Holding Difficult Conversations; create a panel of trainings for supervisors on new online compliance training platform.
- ✓ Seek ways to make the website more user friendly by ensuring the website has a well-organized menu structure and intuitive navigation paths. Team up with the DoIT to reorganize the website to ensure the most important sections are easily accessible from the homepage.
- ✓ Collaborate with DoIT on HR/Finance/Budget system upgrade to include Applicant Tracking System and Employee Self Service.
- ✓ Develop more efficient and modern processing tools to facilitate mandated processes. Future projects include creating an automated exam request workflow, exploring Internet workflow tools to facilitate mandated process with County and local jurisdictions outside of the County network, creating an automated personnel transaction workflow and exploring a new module in NEOGOV for Succession Planning.
- ✓ Participate in the review, testing and configuration of our HR/Payroll system in a significant system update and upgrade which is expected to continue into 2025. This system will replace several existing County systems and lead to the update and revision of several County processes related to these system changes.
- ✓ Work to ensure increased efficiency in the HR/payroll processes including the reduction of paper based processes which will be ongoing.
- ✓ Complete relaunch of the secure website for Local municipalities, school and special districts' authorized civil service contacts to provide them with access to updated forms and procedure manuals. Work to improve the website to make it more user friendly and useful for local jurisdiction contacts.
- ✓ Create and deliver basic training for Local Jurisdictions on forms essential for Civil Service reporting.
- ✓ Update our exam system to accommodate a required change to expand exam numbers provided by NYS Civil Service
- ✓ Review, testing, and configuration of our background check system upgrade

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- ✓ Work on necessary replacement of our ID card printing system.
- ✓ Work closely with some departments on the balance of employee/ employer rights in the administration of FMLA leave.
- ✓ Work with our IT department to decommission an old HR system (Mapper) that holds important employee records.

ON-GOING

- ✓ Review Continuous Recruitment exams regularly and adjust frequency based on need.
- ✓ Simplify the examination registration process by offering an updated step-by-step guide, maintaining and updated FAQ section to address common inquiries and offering comprehensive customer support options.
- ✓ Implement the T&E Correction Officer program, which will eliminate the need to make examination arrangements and pay staff for an in-person examination.
- ✓ Collect information on potential titles to include in the HELP (Hiring for Emergency Limited Placement) program, which is designed to help current provisionals to obtain status and streamline the appointment process in hiring diverse, qualified permanent employees quickly and without examination.
- ✓ Implement the newly established appeal process for candidates who did not meet the Psychological Evaluation standards for Probation Officer, Police Officer and Correction Officer positions.
- ✓ Continue to look for ways to process work more efficiently in order to control expenses.
- ✓ Provide individualized training to new Personnel contacts in County departments and local jurisdictions on how to administer civil service within their agencies, such as eligible list usage and civil service reporting requirements.
- ✓ Review and update of Human Resources Policies posted on the County intranet.
- ✓ Administer Workplace Violence Prevention program to meet state mandates with standardized forms, evaluation and training, new hire training, annual training and worksite evaluation.

- ✓ In collaboration with various other departmental representatives, develop and provide semi-annual supervisory training to managers and supervisors on various topics covering County policies and Communication Strategies to further enhance their skills in effective employee management.
- ✓ Organize Service Award ceremony for employees who reach the milestone anniversary of 25 years of service.
- ✓ Work with all County departments on ways to restructure and reorganize staff as a result of staff turnover; consolidate positions and broaden classifications to allow for more flexibility in staff assignments.
- ✓ Manage and administer third party contracts for Countywide services such as medical and drug testing and temporary personnel.
- ✓ Coordinate and implement sexual harassment prevention training in accordance with New York State mandates.
- ✓ Continue to work with Law to revise the County's Drug Free Workplace Policy including Reasonable Suspicion procedures, Pre-Employment Testing policy and clarifying/updating testing protocols and policy in response to any new legislation, (i.e., recreational marijuana).
- ✓ Maintain and add resources to secure website for Local jurisdictions.

DEPARTMENT ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

ON-GOING

- ✓ Secured vendor to review and update the Department of Correction's current Medical Standards for selecting Correction Officers.
- ✓ Enhanced exam system further to provide valuable functionality such as electronic admission notices, grade notifications and email alerts to registrants.
- ✓ Expanded our role in assisting departments to recruit during a time of significant resignations/retirements in key positions.
- ✓ Ensure ADA compliance requirements are met for all documents on the Human Resources website including all job specifications.

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- ✓ Continued to expand drug and medical testing program to remain in compliance with OSHA standards and to cover more safety-sensitive positions.
- ✓ Developed a series of on-line, skills-based supervisory training modules covering general skills topics to complement our in-person training, which focuses primarily on County-specific policies.
- ✓ Worked with IT to roll out an on-line annual Financial Disclosure reporting system, which has been used successfully in its first year by most employee groups required to file.
- ✓ Assisted in the review and administration of five periods of the NY State Healthcare Worker Bonus program.
- ✓ Assisted the NY State Retirement System with an inquiry regarding the civil service history of approximately 200 Westchester Medical Center employees.

SERVICE INDICATORS:

	2023 Actual	2024 Estimated	2025 Planned
Employee Records and Data Management			
Payrolls Certified	75	80	140
Transactions Processed	72,208	60,000	60,000
County Department Services			
Positions certified/re-certified	414	200	200
Specifications written/revised	284	200	220
County positions reviewed for layoffs			
	15	0	0
Local Jurisdictions			
Reclassification requests	60	60	60
Positions certified	347	360	375
Specifications written/revised	105	150	200
Number of agencies requesting layoff analysis	5	7	7
Number of positions reviewed for layoffs	12	14	15
Employee Recruitment and Selection			
Examinations Administered	384	300	300
Applications reviewed, periodic/decentralize	9,936	8,000	12,000
Pre-Clearance	1,962	1,800	1,800
Eligible Lists Certified	2,078	2,000	2,000
Eligible Lists Established	311	250	250
Physical Abilities Scheduled	284	300	300